

Gophihisng

1- Introduction

I will start explaining the phishing. So, phishing it is a type of hacker attack where they send to the victim a link by SMS or email and in this link contains a malware (a virus). Usually, the messages that they receive it is: “**your account it will be cancel or pending invoice**”. This type of message gives the victims an emotional trigger, that goes directly in the link, inside the link can have a website or download a virus.

On the website the person it will the information (password or credit card), and after they finish and click on the button to confirm, they are submitting the information for the hacker.

Downloading the virus that it is receive by email or SMS, it is even worst, because after the virus is download silently the hacker can take control of your computer to the hacker.

The impact of this type of hacking they are very strong, like stole money from your bank, buying in your credit card, stole information from people. For companies are even worse, it is a crime. They receive a fee to not behaviour with dadas protection

The most emblematic case of phishing in Ireland has happen in 2021 with the **Health Service Executive (HSE)**. Where an employee opened an email phishing, the malware has stayed in the network for weeks allowing the invasivores to map the entire system. This made a huge impact; attack ransomware was released causing a damage of cancel surgery the doctors and nurses they had to use, paper and pens and cost of the impact was 600 millions of euros.

2- Methodology

I started sending an email about 2F (two-factor authentication). I believe that it is a good way to call attention people tend to believe in emails that protect their account and I have used it as a bait. Inside of the email it had a **call attention** where the person could click directly to go for the fake page. The goals were to make the person put the email and the password and them submit, after the submit the page would loading again as the person put “wrong”, with the summation of the dadas I would be able see the email and the password make me able to get in the account.

3- Implementation

Gophish was implemented on a Linux VM because it is more suitable for this type of assignment. Gophish was a good choice for this learning segment as it is an open-source framework. I started by typing './gophish' in the Linux terminal, which runs the service. Inside the terminal, it is possible to find the URL for the browser, along with the initial login and password. After logging into the page, it asks to change the password and then goes to the dashboard. In terms of technical details, the link provided in the terminal is only accessible within the same LAN. On the side menu, we have several options such as:

Tabs and Features:

- **Users and Groups:** In this tab, you can register the targets. It is possible to add a list of emails (via **CSV**) of employees to be tested or add them one by one.
- **Email Template:** This is where the fake email is created. It can be designed using plain text or **HTML**.
- **Landing Page:** Here, the landing page is created. Usually, a real page (like Google or Microsoft) is cloned to try and **capture** user data.
- **Sending Profiles:** This is where you configure the email **settings** and the **technical** part. You define where the email will be sent from, including the display name and the real **credentials** for the SMTP server.
- **Campaign:** In the **campaign** tab, everything is brought together: the group, template, landing page, and sending profile. After you click **launch**, Gophish starts sending emails to everyone and **monitors** who opened the email or who clicked and submitted their data.
- **Webhooks:** This tab is more advanced. Its purpose is to notify and send information to other systems in real-time whenever someone is **phished**.
- **Account Settings:** The place to change your password and configure the **API Key**.
- **User Management:** This **allows** you to **create** other users to help you manage Gophish.
- **User Guide:** A **direct link** to the official project documentation.

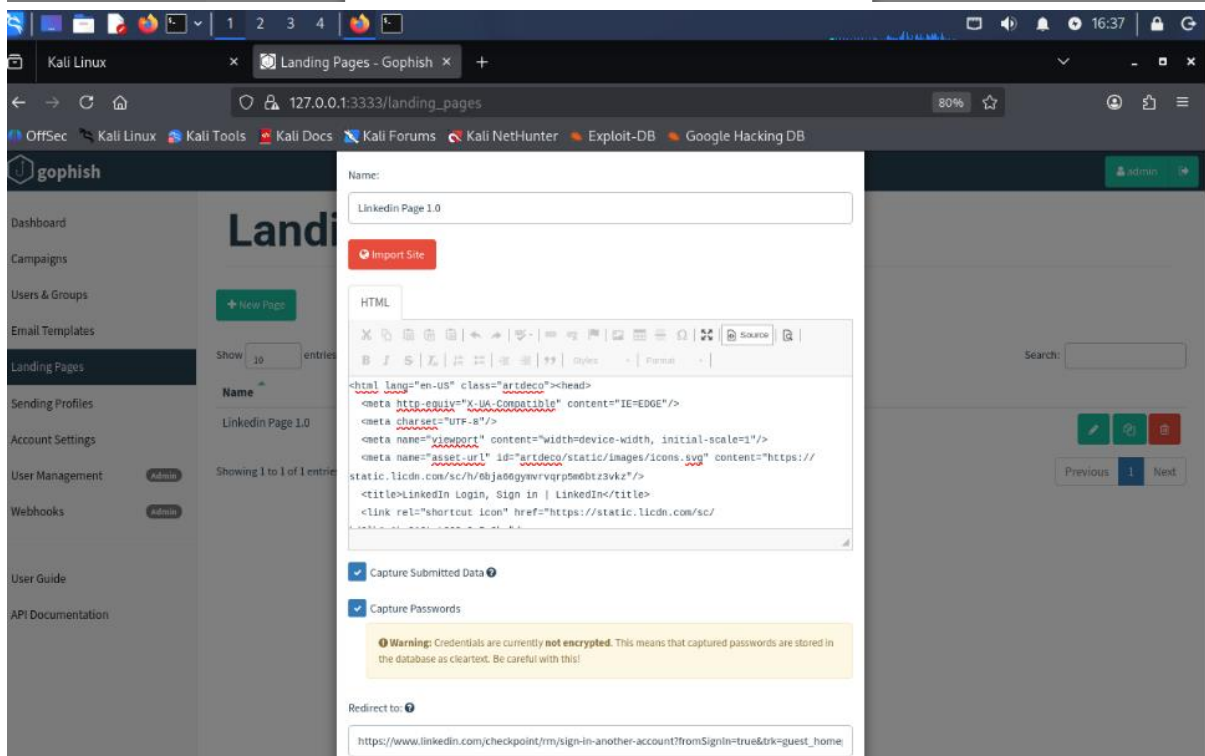
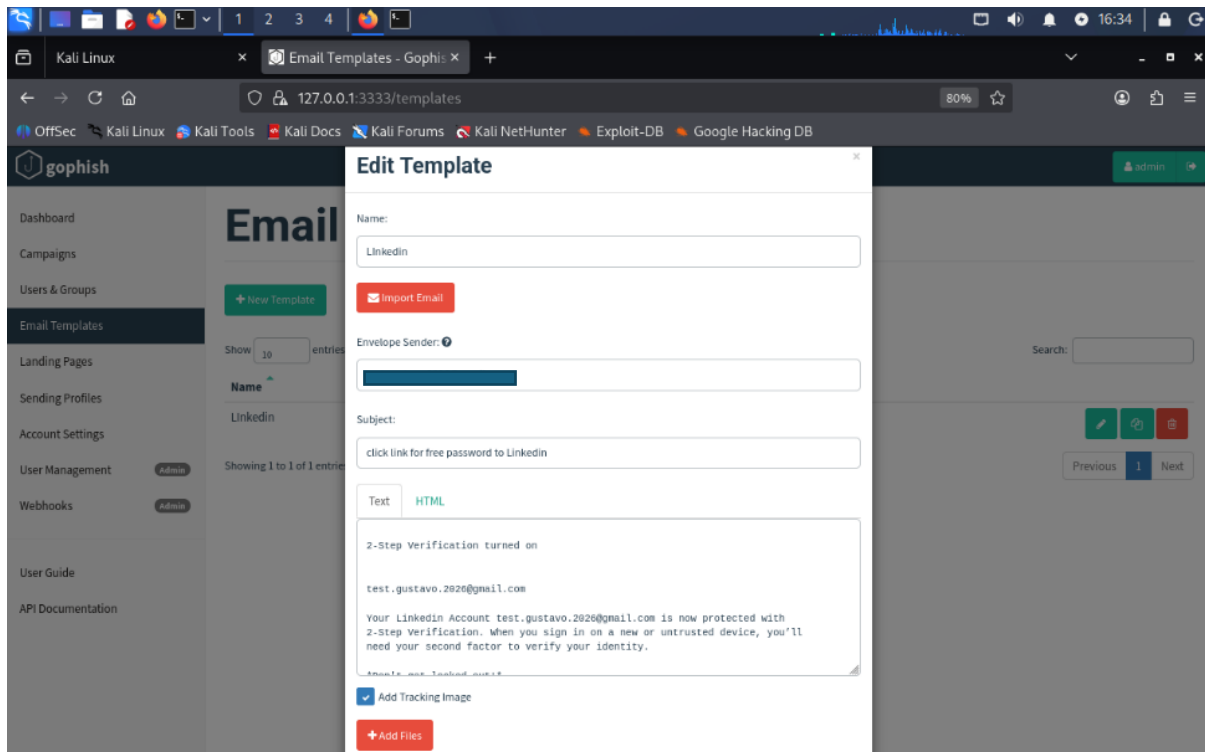
4- Result

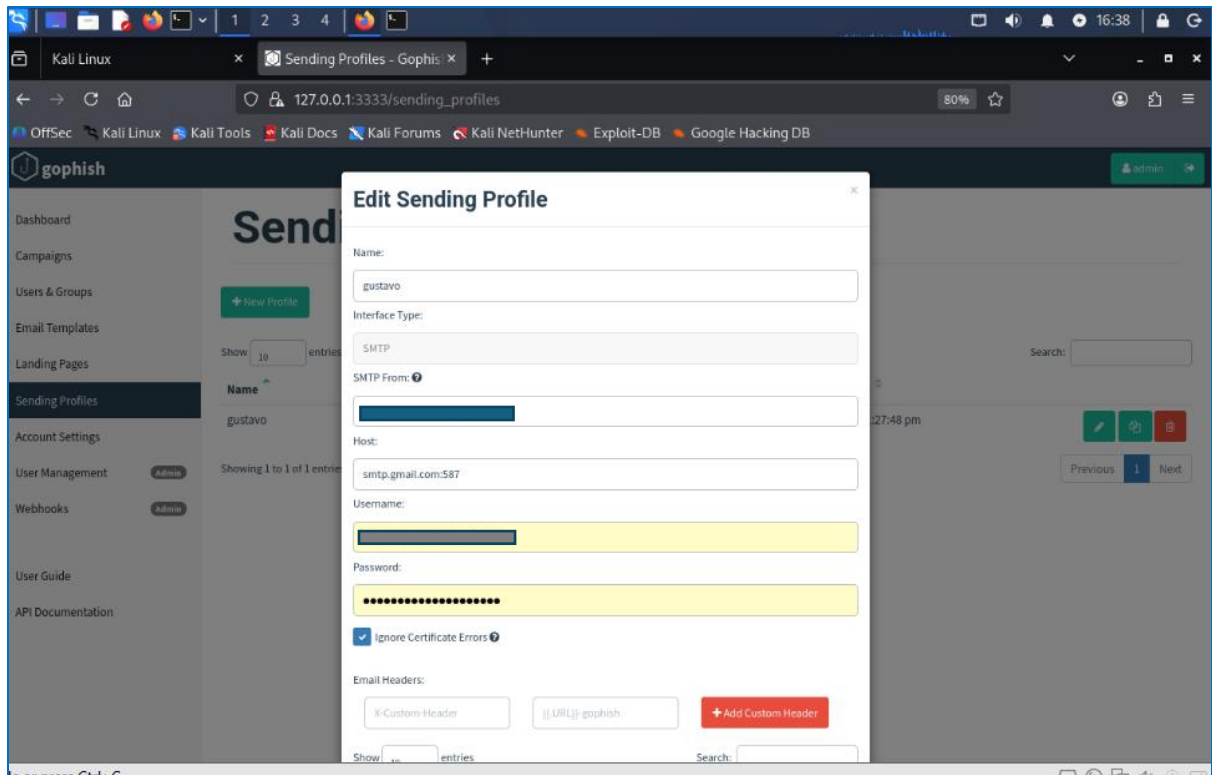
The screenshot displays the Gophish dashboard interface. The top navigation bar includes the Gophish logo and a user profile icon labeled 'admin'. The left sidebar contains a menu with options: Dashboard, Campaigns, Users & Groups, Email Templates, Landing Pages, Sending Profiles, Account Settings, User Management (with an 'Admin' button), Webhooks (with an 'Admin' button), User Guide, and API Documentation.

The main content area features a 'Recent Campaigns' section. At the top, there are five circular progress indicators for different campaign metrics: Email Sent (3), Email Opened (3), Clicked Link (3), Submitted Data (3), and Email Reported (0). Below these is a table of recent campaigns. The table has columns for Name, Created Date, and Status. The first entry is 'hacker camping 1.0', created on 'March 28th 2026, 12:57:03 am', with a status of 'In progress'. The table also includes icons for email, link, and data submission.

The second screenshot shows the 'Users & Groups' section of the Gophish interface. The left sidebar is the same as the first screenshot. The main content area displays a 'New Group' button and a table of users. The table has columns for Name, First Name, Last Name, Email, and Position. The first entry is 'victims', with a first name of 'test', last name of '1', and email of 'test@1.com'. The table also includes a 'Position' column and a 'Status' column.

The third screenshot shows the 'Edit Group' modal window. The modal has a title 'Edit Group' and a 'Name' field containing 'victims'. Below the name field are buttons for 'Bulk Import Users' and 'Download CSV Template'. The modal also includes a table of users with columns for First Name, Last Name, Email, and Position. The first entry is 'test', with a last name of '1' and email of 'test@1.com'. The modal includes a 'Search' field and a 'Show' dropdown menu.





gophish

admin

Dashboard

Campaigns

Users & Groups

Email Templates

Landing Pages

Sending Profiles

Account Settings

User ManagementAdmin

WebhooksAdmin

User Guide

API Documentation

Details

Show 10 entries

Search:

First Name	Last Name	Email	Position	Status	Reported
test	1			Submitted Data	

Timeline for test 1

Email:

Result ID: WlgcsZO

Campaign Created

March 28th 2026 12:57:03 am

Email Sent

March 28th 2026 12:57:05 am

Clicked Link

March 28th 2026 12:57:39 am

Linux (OS Version: x86_64)

Firefox (Version: 140.0)

Submitted Data

March 28th 2026 12:58:10 am

Linux (OS Version: x86_64)

Firefox (Version: 140.0)

Replay Credentials

View Details

gophish

admin

Dashboard

Campaigns

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WebhooksAdmin

User Guide

API Documentation

test

1

Submitted Data

test

3

Submitted Data

Timeline for test 3

Email:

Result ID: w6LDwe9

Campaign Created

March 28th 2026 12:57:03 am

Email Sent

March 28th 2026 12:57:06 am

Clicked Link

March 28th 2026 10:14:32 am

Linux (OS Version: x86_64)

Firefox (Version: 140.0)

Submitted Data

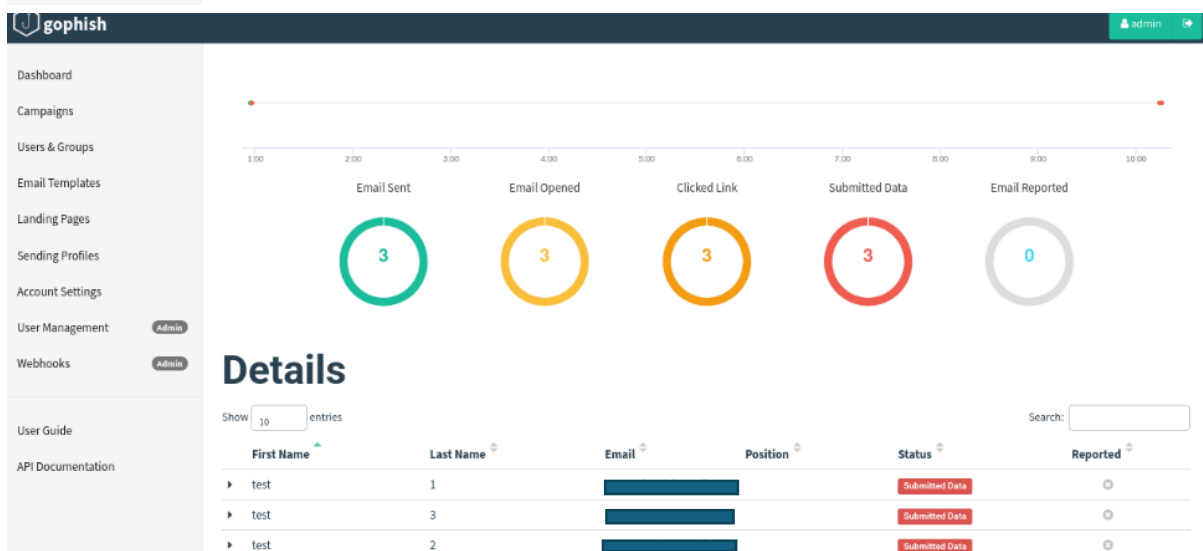
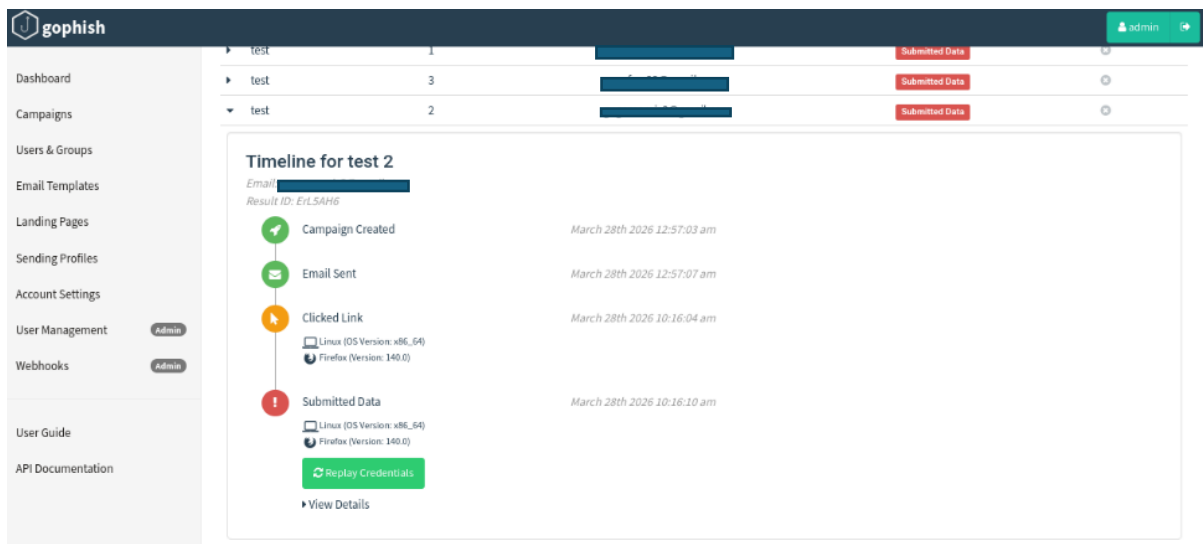
March 28th 2026 10:14:40 am

Linux (OS Version: x86_64)

Firefox (Version: 140.0)

Replay Credentials

View Details



5- Discussion

Why Phishing is Effective

Phishing is still a big threat because it attacks not only the software but security as a whole. The reason why it works is because it is cheap and yields high profits. For the attacker, it is easy to escalate the number of victims; with one click, thousands of emails are sent.

Using the right tools and current designs, it is easy to clone a website. The attacks are always changing; they can be about health, technology, or taxes. It follows the relevance of what is happening in the world at the moment. In this case, there is always a fresh bait

6- Conclusion

The ease of configuring Gophish shows how low the **technical barrier** for cyberattacks has become. In the right scenario, with the right tools, it is easy to **access** any type of **system**. I believe the **human factor** is the biggest **threat** in this context, as we can be triggered by small things every day, giving attackers space to **exploit** our weaknesses.

The best **defense** against cyberattacks is **knowledge**. With the right education, we can lower the risk of a successful attack. This type of **assignment** is important because it shows us how attacks happen and how they usually come from people with **bad intentions**. It is vital that stories like the **HSE attack here in Ireland** are shared with the population so it **doesn't** happen again, and so we can be **prepared** and ready to face these types of problems.